

Sir Oliver and the Quest for a Shining Courtyard

Knight's story • 3-4 years old



Part One: The Messy Courtyard

Once upon a time, in a bright green kingdom full of sun and songbirds, lived a little knight. His name was Sir Oliver, and he was a dreamer. Sir Oliver loved to look at the clouds and think about grand adventures. He wore a shiny silver helmet, a red feather in his cap, and a gentle smile every day.

One morning, Sir Oliver woke up in his cozy castle bed. He stretched his arms and peeked out the window. "Oh dear," he said, rubbing his eyes. The courtyard was full of twigs, leaves, and little pebbles. The wind had danced all night and made a mess.

Sir Oliver put on his armor. He wanted the courtyard to shine for all his friends. "Today, I will clean the courtyard," he said. He picked up his wooden broom and marched outside.

But the courtyard was very big. Sir Oliver looked at all the twigs and leaves. "This is a big job," he whispered, but his heart was brave. He took a deep breath. His dog, Daisy, wagged her tail and followed him. "Don't worry, Daisy. We can do this together," said Sir Oliver.

Part Two: The Great Cleaning Quest

Sir Oliver started to sweep. Swish, swish, went the broom. The leaves danced away. Daisy barked and chased a rolling pebble. Sir Oliver laughed. "Good dog, Daisy! Let's keep going!"

But soon, Sir Oliver saw something big. A pile of prickly sticks blocked the path. Sir Oliver stopped. The sticks looked sharp and tangled. He felt a little worried. He remembered what his mother said: "Brave knights use their minds and their hearts."

Sir Oliver looked at Daisy. "Maybe we can move the sticks together," he said. Daisy wagged her tail. Sir Oliver picked up one stick, then another. He worked slowly, careful not to get poked. Daisy helped by pulling a small branch with her teeth. Together, they moved the whole pile.

Sir Oliver smiled. "We did it, Daisy! Knights are always brave and kind." Daisy jumped and licked his hand.

Now, the path was clear, but the wind blew again. Some leaves flew back. Sir Oliver's shoulders drooped. "Oh no, more leaves," he sighed. But he remembered his dream. He wanted the courtyard to shine. He did not give up.

He called to his friend, Mia the kind squire. "Mia, can you help us?" Mia came running with a big smile and a soft brush. "Of course, Sir Oliver!" she said.

Sir Oliver, Daisy, and Mia swept and gathered leaves together. They sang a happy song. "We are the Courtyard Knights, brave and bright! We sweep and clean from morning to night!"

The sun grew warm, and the pile of leaves grew high. Sir Oliver saw a tiny mouse under a leaf. The mouse was scared. Sir Oliver knelt down.

"It's okay, little mouse," he said softly. "We will not hurt you. You can play in the garden." Sir Oliver gently moved the leaves. The mouse squeaked and scurried away, happy and safe.

Sir Oliver felt proud. "Being gentle is part of being a great knight," he whispered.

Part Three: The Shining Courtyard

By afternoon, the courtyard was almost clean. Sir Oliver, Daisy, and Mia looked around. Only a few pebbles were left. Sir Oliver picked them up, one by one.

Each pebble felt like a tiny treasure.

When the last pebble was gone, the courtyard sparkled in the sunshine. The birds sang from the trees. The castle doors opened, and friends came outside.

“Wow!” said the king. “The courtyard is beautiful!” The queen clapped her hands. “Sir Oliver, you did it! You were brave, smart, and very kind.” Mia smiled and hugged him. Daisy barked and wagged her tail.

Sir Oliver blushed. “We did it together,” he said. “Everyone helped. That’s a knight’s way.” The friends gathered in the clean courtyard. They danced and played and shared sweet berry pies.

Sir Oliver lay on the grass, looking at the sky. He saw a cloud shaped like a dragon. He smiled and dreamed of new adventures. But today, he was happy and proud. The courtyard shone bright, and his heart was full.

And so, Sir Oliver’s cleaning quest became a tale of friendship, courage, and kindness. In the bright green kingdom, every day was a new adventure, and every knight knew that the bravest thing of all was to be gentle and caring.

The sun set over the castle. Sir Oliver and Daisy walked inside, ready for a warm supper and a cozy bed. “Goodnight, Daisy,” Sir Oliver whispered. “Tomorrow, we will dream of new adventures.” Daisy curled up beside him, and together, they drifted into gentle dreams.

In the peaceful castle, all was calm and safe. And the brave little knight, with his big, gentle heart, slept soundly, ready for another happy day.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) Who is the little knight in the story?

- Sir Oliver
- Sir Tom
- Prince Alex
- King John

2) What is the name of the little knight's dog?

- Daisy
- Bella
- Spot
- Rex

3) What did Sir Oliver and his friends clean?

- The courtyard
- The bedroom
- The kitchen
- The market

4) Who helped Sir Oliver sweep the courtyard?

- Mia the squire
- The dragon
- A farmer
- A teacher

Correct answers:

1) Sir Oliver 2) Daisy 3) The courtyard 4) Mia the squire

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Courtyard: An open area near a house or castle where people can play.

Twigs: Small, thin pieces of wood that fall from trees.

Pebbles: Small, smooth stones you find on the ground.

Prickly sticks: Sharp, pointy sticks that can poke your skin.

Tangled: When things are all mixed up and hard to pull apart.

Squire: A helper for a knight who carries things and learns to be brave.

Scurried: To run quickly with short, small steps.

Sparkled: Shone with many little bright lights or spots.

Gentle: Soft and kind, not rough or mean.

Squeaked: Made a very small, high sound, like a tiny mouse.

Armor: Hard clothes made to keep a knight safe in a fight.